

IMLS Public Libraries Survey FY 2019-2023 — Data Dictionary

Source: Institute of Museum and Library Services (IMLS), Public Libraries Survey, Fiscal Years 2019 - 2023. Data collected from 9,252 public library administrative entities across all 50 U.S. states and DC.

Unit of analysis: One row = one library administrative entity (a legally established public library system, which may operate one or more physical outlets/branches).

Missing and suppressed values: Negative numbers carry specific meanings and should be excluded from analysis rather than treated as zeros.

-1	Library did not report a value	Most numeric fields
-3	Library was temporarily closed during the reporting year	Most numeric fields
-9	Data suppressed for confidentiality (libraries with ≤2 FTE staff)	STAFFEXP
-9	Out-of-scope designation (35 California county law libraries excluded from state/national analysis)	POPU_LSA

Identity & Geography

LIBNAME	Library Name	Text	Legal name of the library administrative entity
STABR	State	Text	Two-letter state abbreviation (e.g., NY, CA)
CNTY	County	Text	County in which the library's headquarters is located
LOCALE_ADD	Locale Type	Text	Urban-centric locale classification assigned using the NCES locale framework: City (Large / Mid-size / Small), Suburban (Large / Mid-size / Small), Town (Fringe / Distant / Remote), or Rural (Fringe / Distant / Remote)
POPU_LSA	Service Area Population	Number	Number of people in the geographic area the library is established to serve
FSCKEY	Library ID	Number	Unique library identifier
LONGITUD	Longitude	Number	Longitude for library's headquarters location
LATITUDE	Latitude	Number	Latitude for library's headquarters location

Scale & Structure

TOTSTAFF	Total Paid Staff (FTE)	Decimal	Total full-time equivalent paid employees, including librarians and all other staff
BRANLIB	Number of Branch Libraries	Number	Count of branch locations operated by this library system, excluding the central library

Operating Revenue

TOTINCM	Total Operating Revenue (\$)	Number	Total annual revenue available for operating expenditures, from all sources
LOGVLT	Local Government Revenue (\$)	Number	Portion of operating revenue from local government funding

Operating Expenditures

STAFFEXP	Total Staff Expenditures (\$)	Number	Total spending on salaries, wages, and employee benefits
PRMATEXP	Print Materials Expenditures (\$)	Number	Spending on physical collection materials (books, serials, government documents)
ELMATEXP	Electronic Materials Expenditures (\$)	Number	Spending on digital collection materials (e-books, databases, downloadable audio/video)

Collection

BKVOL	Print Materials (volumes)	Number	Total physical items in the collection, including books and government documents
EBOOK	Electronic Books	Number	Total e-book units held or licensed by the library

Services & Usage

VISITS	Annual Library Visits	Number	Total number of persons entering the library during the year, for any purpose

TOTCIR	Total Annual Circulation	Number	Total annual checkout transactions across all physical and electronic materials
ELMATCIR	Electronic Materials Circulation	Number	Annual circulation of electronic materials only (e-books, downloadable audio/video)
PHYSCIR	Physical Materials Circulation	Number	Annual circulation of physical materials only
TOTPRO	Total Program Sessions	Number	Total number of synchronous (live) programs offered during the year, in any format or venue

Digital Access

GPTERMS	Public Internet Computers	Number	Number of internet-connected computers available for public use
WIFISESS	Annual WiFi Sessions	Number	Total annual wireless sessions provided by library WiFi